

Instructor: Date:

Learner: Regional Branch:

Program: Center:

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Let's Start!

The Event Takes Shape



Learning Outcome

Exchange information about people's interests and backgrounds using a wider range of language.

Ask your partner:

- Which corporations in your community are socially responsible?
- Can companies be trusted to behave ethically, or do they need to be regulated?

Can Do Statements

- I can explain facts and my point of view on work-related topics.
- I can give a supported argument about work-related processes that would benefit me and my employer.
- I can put forth ideas and react to others' ideas during a business discussion.





Let's Explore!

The company tries to get back **on the right track***.

* To be "on the right track" is to be going in the correct direction or doing the right thing.



Instructions: Read the text aloud.

- Miranda:** So, we're here to plan our event. Shouldn't you be taking notes, Peter?
- Peter:** I am, actually. So ... isn't the idea to integrate corporate social responsibility into this new business model just a way of attracting more consumers?
- Ferdinand:** Yes and no. It might attract new customers, but research suggests current customers respond better when companies do charity work.
- Miranda:** If they support the company, they ought to be loyal and willing to spend more. But above all, the company ought to comply with ethical standards and develop a sense of responsibility toward the community. Shouldn't contributing to educational and social programs be the whole point of doing this?
- Ferdinand:** Yes.
- Miranda:** Okay. Wouldn't it be better if we focused mainly on the event? We'd better set a date.
- Ferdinand:** Haven't we decided on one already?
- Miranda:** We have for the external launch. Do you think we should set a date to launch the rebranding internally?
- Ferdinand:** That's a good idea. We might want to do it internally prior to an external launch. That way we can troubleshoot any problems that may arise.
- Miranda:** How about a speaker? Can't we have Rocco as the main speaker?
- Ferdinand:** I've already checked with him and he's available. You might want to include Farmani as well. It's his company.
- Miranda:** Right. That ought to be discussed. Maybe a short intro and a few lines. Didn't the venue manager call to confirm availability?
- Peter:** Yes. We can check that off the list.
- Ferdinand:** I have confirmed the budget and contacted the press. We're good to go!
- Miranda:** Excellent!





Let's Practice!

A *forward-thinking conversation.

* "Forward-thinking" means progressive or innovative.

Instructions: Read the sentences. Write the missing words. Choose from: check that off, charity work, ethical standards, develop a sense of responsibility, business model, and external lunch. Read the sentences aloud. Compare yourself to a partner. Correct each other's intonations and pronunciation.

1. We can _____ the list.
2. Consumers respond better when companies do _____.
3. The company ought to comply with _____.
4. The company ought to _____ towards the community.
5. Isn't the idea to integrate corporate social responsibility into this new _____?
6. We have decided on one for the _____.



Let's Practice!

Miranda and Ferdinand ask some negative questions!

Instructions: Choose words from below to correctly complete the sentences. Read the completed sentences aloud. Check your pronunciation with your instructor.

1. Shouldn't you _____ taking notes, Peter? be / being / been
2. _____ the idea to integrate corporate social responsibility into this new business model? Isn't / Aren't / Don't
3. _____ we decided on one already? Won't / Will / Haven't
4. _____ you think we should set a date to launch the rebranding internally? Are / Haven't / Don't
5. _____ we have Rocco as the main speaker? Can't / Isn't / Are
6. _____ the venue manager call to confirm availability? Do / Are / Didn't



Extension Activity

Research a company's ethical standards.

Instructions: Complete the following steps. Fill in the Self-Assessment.

- Go online and research a company's ethical standards.
- Take note of the ways in which the company is socially responsible.
- Share your findings with another classmate.
- Discuss how you think the company is able to meet all the ethical standards.

Self-Assessment

Yes

No

I read about a company's ethical standards.

☐ ☐

I take notes about the ways in which the company is socially responsible.

☐ ☐

I discuss my findings with another classmate.

☐ ☐

I explain facts and my point of view to others.

☐ ☐


Target Words

- to integrate** (verb): to combine two or more things into one
e.g. Isn't the idea to integrate corporate social responsibility into this new business model?
- business model** (noun): a representation of how different parts of a business will work together
e.g. This new business model has been approved by the board.
- do charity work** (expression): to help people in need; to do something that will benefit society
e.g. Research suggests current consumers respond better when companies do charity work.
- ethical standards** (noun): a measure or benchmark of what is morally right or wrong
e.g. The company ought to comply with ethical standards and develop a sense of responsibility towards the community.
- to develop a sense of** (expression): to get an understanding or an idea of something
e.g. I would like to develop a sense of community.
- launch** (noun): the introduction of a new product to the public
e.g. We have prepared for the external launch.
- to check off** (expression): to mark something as complete
e.g. We can check that off the list.





Learning Points

Expressing Advice

There are many different ways to make recommendations and express advice. The modal verbs 'had better', 'ought to' and 'might' are most commonly used to make recommendations.

Had better

1. Form: subject + had better + bare infinitive (verb without 'to')
2. Meaning: "had better" is very similar in meaning to should but it is stronger because it implies a negative consequence if the advice is not followed.

Ought to

1. Form: subject + ought to + bare infinitive (verb without 'to')
2. Meaning: "ought to" is used for saying what you think is the right thing to do.

Might

1. Form: subject + might + bare infinitive (verb without 'to')
2. Meaning: "might" is used for making a suggestion or recommendation. It's not as strong as "had better." We commonly use the verb "have" with "might."

Examples:

- We believe this idea might attract more people to our business.
- The new clients ought to be loyal to our company.
- We 'd better pick a date for the event now.
- That is something that ought to be discussed soon.
- You might want to include him in this conversation.





Learning Points

Asking Negative Questions

When asking questions in English, we sometimes use negative questions. They have a different word order and can be contracted and uncontracted.

Contracted negative questions follow this form: auxiliary verb + n't + subject + verb

Uncontracted negative questions are usually more formal and follow this form: auxiliary verb + not + subject + verb

Negative questions are commonly used to ask for confirmation of something you believe is true or to ask for confirmation of a negative belief - the speaker is surprised in this case.

Examples:

- *Shouldn't you be writing this down?*
- *Isn't this idea just a new way of attracting more people to buy our products?*
- *Wouldn't it be better if we talked about this later?*
- *Haven't we decided on a date yet?*

